

was scheduled for 5.45pm on 17 April and the train reached Bori Bunder at 7.00pm.

This glorious event was snubbed by the Governor of Bombay, Lord Falkland, who chose to retreat to his hill station home, though his wife was present on the day. After the event, *Overland Telegraph and Courier* wrote: "the opening of the Great Indian Peninsula Railway will be remembered by the natives of India when the battle fields of Plassey, Assaye, Meanee, and Goojerat have become the landmarks of history." The *Illustrated Weekly of London* reported: "the long line of carriages conveying nearly 500 passengers glided smoothly and easily away amidst the shouts of assembled thousands."

The excitement was palpable among the locals. So much so that, the very next day, Jeejeebhoy booked the entire train to travel to Thana and back with his family and friends.



▲ **A crowd waiting** at the Byculla station, which was also the starting point for trials of the first passenger steam locomotive.